

GEUMBI PARK

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Education

Ph.D. Economics, Texas A&M University, 2020-2026 (*expected*)
M.A. Economics, University of Virginia, 2019
M.A. Economics, Seoul National University, South Korea, 2018
B.A. Economics, Ewha Womans[sic] University, South Korea, 2015
Double Major: International Office Administration, Minor: Mathematics

Research Fields

Macroeconomics, Industrial Organization, Public Economics

Job Market Paper

“Product Market Dynamics over the Business Cycle”

Abstract: Business cycles reshape product market dynamics, but these responses differ markedly across markets. This heterogeneity arises from differences in consumer demand structures and their interaction with producers’ entry and exit decisions—an aspect largely overlooked in the literature. This paper examines how product entry and exit over the business cycle depend on the structure of consumer demand. I develop a model of strategic firm dynamics under imperfect competition with heterogeneous producers and consumers, allowing demand composition to shape the evolution of market structure. Using detailed scanner data from the consumer goods sector, I estimate the model separately for each differentiated product market to analyze producer responses during the Great Recession. I find that negative aggregate demand shocks lead firms to reduce entry and increase exit, with the magnitude of these responses varying systematically with the price elasticity of demand. Markets with less elastic demand experience larger contractions in product variety, and interactions between elasticity and product characteristics further amplify recessionary effects. I also show that the welfare costs of the business cycle are substantially larger when accounting for demand heterogeneity, with most losses stemming from declines in consumer surplus. In the absence of consumer heterogeneity, the welfare loss is significantly understated. Overall, the results demonstrate that consumer heterogeneity is a key driver of how recessions affect market structure and welfare.

Presentations: (2025) SEA Annual Meeting, Fall Midwest Macroeconomics Meeting, Texas Macro Job Candidate Conference, BC PhD Conference in Economics, Texas A&M Macro Mini-Conference (poster) (2024) SEA Annual Meeting, Federal Reserve Board, North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society, ASSA Annual Meeting (2023) SEA Annual Meeting

Working Paper

“Subcontracting in Federal Spending: Micro and Macro Implications,” with Xiaoqing Zhou and Sarah Zubairy (*Dallas Fed Working Paper* No. 2535)

Publication

“Minimum Wage, Employment, and Margins of Adjustment: Evidence from Employer–Employee Matched Panel Data,” with Jungmin Lee, *Journal of Human Resources*, January 2026, Vol.61, No. 1: 211-239

Works in Progress

“When to Create, When to Improve: Product and Process Innovation over the Business Cycle” with Rohan Shah
“Corporate Governance and Marginal Tax Cuts: The Influence of Institutional Investors” with Sunju Hwang

Research and Work Experience

AEA Summer Economics Fellow, Federal Reserve Board, 2024
Research Assistant to Professor Sarah Zubairy, Texas A&M University, 2022-2024
Research Assistant to Professor Yoon Joo Jo, Texas A&M University, 2022
Research Analyst, Korea Institute of Public Finance, 2019-2020
Research Assistant to Professor Jungmin Lee, Seoul National University, 2016-2018

Teaching Experience

Texas A&M University
Instructor: Macroeconomic Theory, Summer 2023
 Macroeconomics Qualifier Camp (Ph.D.), Summer 2022

Teaching Assistant: Macroeconomic Theory, Spring 2025
 Directed Studies, Fall 2024
 Macroeconomic Theory I (Ph.D.), Fall 2021
 Economic Development, Spring 2021

Honors and Awards

Luke Soules III Graduate Fellowship in Global Macroeconomics, Texas A&M University, 2025
E. Ralph Daniel Scholarship, Texas A&M University, 2024-2025
S. Charles Maurice Fellowship, Texas A&M University, 2024
Gail Frey Monson Memorial Scholarship, Texas A&M University, 2024
Graduate Research Fund, Texas A&M University, 2022-2023
Princeton Initiative: Macro, Money, and Finance, Princeton University, 2022
Graduate Assistantship, Texas A&M University, 2020-present
University Fellowship, University of Virginia, 2018-2019
Brain Korea 21 Scholarship, National Research Foundation of Korea, Fall 2015, 2016-2017
Dean's List, Ewha Womans University, Fall 2013, Fall 2014

Discussions

"Monopsony Power in the Publishing Industry" by Maximiliano Machado, at BC PhD Conference in Economics, 2025
"Allocating Upgrades: Challenges and Opportunities in the Airline Industry" by Alex Marsh, Garrett Scott, Jonathan Williams, at SEA Annual Meeting, 2024

Service

Dissertation Fellows Panel, Federal Reserve Board, 2024
Representative, Economics Graduate Student Association, Texas A&M University, 2023-2024

Additional Information

Language: English (Fluent), Korean (Native)
Computation: Julia, Matlab, Stata
Citizenship: South Korea (F1-visa)

References

Professor Sarah Zubairy, Texas A&M University, szubairy@tamu.edu
Professor Pedro Bento, Texas A&M University, pbento@tamu.edu
Professor Fernando Luco, Texas A&M University, fluco@tamu.edu